

Five Phases of Ethical Hacking - Cheat Sheet

1. Reconnaissance (Information Gathering)

Goal: Collect information about the target.

Types: Passive (Google, WHOIS), Active (Ping, Traceroute).

Tools: Google Dorking, Shodan, Recon-ng, Maltego, NSLookup.

2. Scanning

Goal: Identify open ports, services, and vulnerabilities.

Types: Port scanning, Vulnerability scanning, Network mapping.

Tools: Nmap, Nessus, Nikto, OpenVAS.

3. Gaining Access

Goal: Exploit vulnerabilities to gain control.

Methods: Brute-force, SQL Injection, Exploiting web flaws.

Tools: Metasploit, Hydra, SQLMap, Burp Suite.

4. Maintaining Access

Goal: Remain in the system after initial access.

Methods: Backdoors, Privilege escalation, Rootkits.

Tools: Netcat, Meterpreter, custom scripts.

5. Covering Tracks

Goal: Erase evidence of the attack.

Methods: Log deletion, hiding files/processes.

Tools: Manual log clearing, timestomping utilities.

Note: Ethical hackers simulate this only.